Call me Ishmael; when I grow grim, I take to sea.

I join the water-gazers at the Battery.

I feel my thoughts wedded to the water.

I always go to sea as a sailor, because they make a point of paying me.

I arrive with my old carpet-bag on a Saturday night, waiting a Nantucket craft.

I hunt cheap lodging, blunder into a church, and back out into the cold.

I eye the Spouter's creaking sign and go in, omen or no.

I stare until I feel a dim, unimaginable sublimity.

I stand beneath a whale's jaw while the barman bustles within.

I am offered half a bed with a harpooneer.

I watched the Grampus men blow in from the ice, crying for Bulkington.

I change my mind and ask for the bench instead.

I would rather not sleep two in a bed.

I hear a baffling hint about him ‘selling his head.’

I learn he peddles ‘balmed’ New Zealand heads, and I call him dangerous.

I follow the landlord upstairs to a prodigious, cold bed.

I never saw such a sight in my life.

I turned in—then came a heavy footfall, and a light under the door.

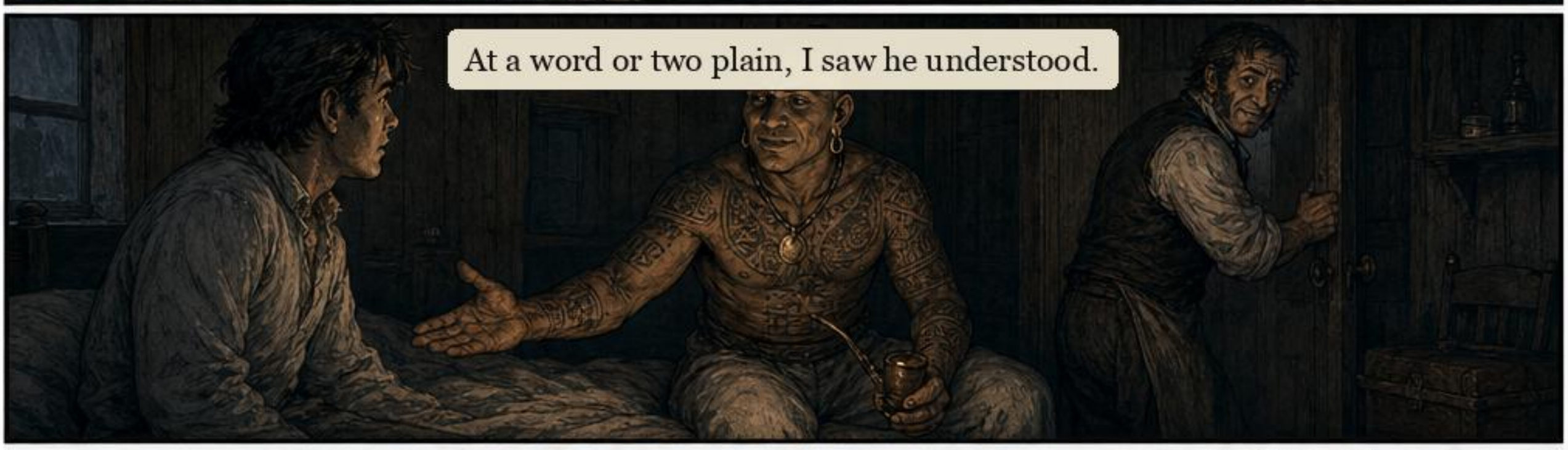
Had not the stranger stood between me and the door, I would have bolted.

I watched his strange idol rite and heard stranger guttural sounds.


I saw him light his tomahawk-pipe, snuff the light, and spring into my bed.


I yelled till the landlord burst in with a light.


I heard the landlord swear Queequeg wouldn't harm a hair of my head.


At a word or two plain, I saw he understood.


I made him stash the pipe, turned in, and never slept better in my life.